CHRISTIAN KONTZ

Stanford University ◇ Graduate School of Business
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EDUCATION

Stanford University, Graduate School of Business *2020–present*
Ph.D. Candidate in Finance
Dissertation Committee: Hanno Lustig (chair), Monika Piazzesi, Amit Seru, Juliane Begenau

Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, Universitat Pompeu Fabra *2018*
Master in International Trade, Finance, and Development

University of Hamburg *2017*
B.Sc. in Economics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial Intermediation, Corporate Finance, Climate Finance

WORKING PAPERS

1. *The Real Cost of Benchmarking* with Sebastian Hanson [SSRN]
   Awards: Winner of FIRS 2025 Conference Prize for PhD Students and SFS Cavalcade 2025 PhD Student Award
   Media: Bloomberg's Matt Levine Money Stuff Newsletter
2. *Do ESG Investors Care About Carbon Emissions? Evidence From Securitized Auto Loans* [SSRN]
   Awards: Winner of UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025, GRASFI Conference 2024 Best PhD Paper Award, Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize, FIRS 2024 Conference Prize for PhD Students

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. *From Markets to Meters: How Index Investing Affects Utility Rates*
2. *The Cross-section of Prices* with Hanno Lustig and Miguel Chumbo
3. *ESG Induced Capital Misallocation: is ESG Doing Good, by Doing Well?*

PRESENTATIONS (*SCHEDULED, ^{c}CO-AUTHOR)

2026 Seminars: NYU Stern, Boston College Carroll, UT Austin McCombs, Ohio State University Fisher, Notre Dame Mendoza, University of Virginia Darden, University of Maryland Smith, Bocconi University, Copenhagen Business School, National University of Singapore, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, Singapore Management University

Conferences: AFA 2026

2025 Seminars: Citadel, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar

Conferences: SFS Cavalcade, FIRS 2025, AFA 2025 (2x Poster), Four Corners Conference on Indexing, Johns Hopkins Carey Finance Conference, UIC Finance Conference^c, Northeastern Uni Finance Conference, Investment Company Institute, German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (UHH)

2024 Seminars: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2x), Citadel^c

Conferences: FIRS 2024, SoFiE 2024, GRASFI 2024, OU-RFS Climate and Energy Conference, UC Santa Cruz CAFIN, CEPR-ESSEC-Luxembourg Conference on Sustainable Financial Intermediation, FMA, MFR Session for Young Scholars (Poster), German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (CESifo)

2023 Workshops: Harvard Climate Economics Workshop, UChicago Workshop on Climate, Uncertainty, and Policy, NYU Shanghai/SoFiE Summer School

Conferences: MFR/IMSI Conference (Poster)

2022 Conferences: German Economists Abroad Annual Meeting (DIW)

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

Shortlisted for Brandes Center Prize 2024	*2025*
UN PRI Best PhD Student Paper in 2025	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2025*
SFS Cavalcade PhD Student Award	*2025*
Stanford GSB Academic Career Advancement Fellowship	*2025-2026*
Finalist 5th Annual Sustainable Finance in Fixed Income Research Competition (FIASI)	*2025*
American Finance Association Travel Grant (AFA Annual Meeting)	*2025*
FIRS Conference Prize for PhD Students	*2024*
Myron S. Scholes PhD Prize	*2024*
GRASFI Conference Best PhD Paper Award	*2024*
Graduate Fellowship, Stanford Graduate School of Business	*2020–2025*
Pre-doctoral Fellowship, Julis-Rabinowitz Center at Princeton University	*2018–2020*
Undergraduate and Graduate Fellowship, Friedrich-Naumann-Foundation for Freedom	*2015–2018*

OTHER RESEARCH POSITIONS

US Census Bureau *2022-present*
Special Sworn Status (SSS)

The Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE Frankfurt *April 2025*
Visiting Researcher

University of Chicago *Spring 2023*
Visiting Student, invited by Fernando Alvarez, Lars Hansen, and Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

Princeton University *2018–2020*
Research Assistant to Natalie Cox, Moritz Lenel, and Adrien Matray

University of Hamburg *2016–2017*
Research Assistant to Christiane Hellmanzik and Mu-Chun Wang

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Base Finance, TA to Juliane Begenau	*2022, 2023*
Capital Markets and Institutional Investing, TA to Hanno Lustig and Ana Marshall	*2023, 2024, 2025*
Corporations, Finance, and Governance in the Global Economy, TA to Amit Seru	*2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
Debt Markets, TA to Darrell Duffie	*2021, 2022*
Modeling for Investment Management, TA to Steven Grenadier	*2023, 2024, 2025*

University of Hamburg

Macroeconomics 1 (UG), TA to Kristin Paetz	*2016*

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee: Journal of Finance, Management Science
Lecture Series Organization: Stanford Lecture Series on the History of Economic Thought (2020/21)
Media: Frankfurter Allgemeine (in German)

Seminar Series Organization: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar (2024/25), GSB Finance Brown Bag (2022/23)

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and CFO, vierfreunde GmbH (*Kerbholz - wooden fashion accessories*) *2011–2014*
Apprenticeship as Industriekaufmann (industrial business management assistant) *2009–2011*

REFERENCES

Hanno Lustig (primary advisor)
The Mizuho Financial Group Professor of Finance
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